

Yale University Questions

General

Preferred start term	Fall 2018
Admission plan	Restrictive Early Action
Financial aid	Yes
Arts Supplement¹	No

Academics

As of this moment, what academic areas seem to fit your interests or goals most comfortably? Please indicate up to three.

Computer Science

Other Academic Interests?

Economics

Why do these areas appeal to you?

Computer science appeals to me as it is a world of fascinating principles that would enable me to devise a solution to the slow technological development in Kenya. Economics explains how people with limited resources make decisions in terms of business. With expertise in both disciplines, I hope to become an outstanding computer scientist having developed a deep understanding of computer systems and decision-making in business. Ultimately, I aspire to spread technological awareness to Kenya, where access to computers is limited and computer literacy is inadequate, by setting up a technology firm and training center.

Contacts

Previously Applied	No
Contact 1	Website
Contact 2	Other

Family

Sibling applied	No
Relatives attended member	No
Relative employed at member	No

Additional Questions

Why Yale

With Yale's liberal approach during the shopping period, comes freedom to explore my problem-solving interests. I imagine running a mock meeting of the National Security Council dealing with a crisis under the guidance of a member of the Council and the former commander of American forces in Afghanistan. Or learning from iconic innovators during the Yale Entrepreneurial Society's Eli Series. I would gain a heightened sense of solutions to world problems and join the Yale College Freshman Summer Research Fellowship. Here, I'd work closely with Yale's brightest minds in finding solutions to Kenya's slow technological development.

Whether I'm at the Blue-Booking party, gracing next year's Camp Yale, or competing for the Tyng Cup, I want to be part of Yale's tightly-knit community; Bow-wow-wow Eli Yale!

1. What inspires you?	My vision of a future where every Kenyan's story will start, "I first saw a computer when I was two!" A future where my struggle of growing up with limited access to computers will be non-existent.
Yale's residential colleges regularly host intimate conversations with guests representing a wide range of experiences and	The founder of Snap Inc., Evan Spiegel. I'd love to ask how he keeps Snapchat unique and authentic in a market that has become flooded by different innovations and applications that resemble his.

accomplishments.

What person, past or present, would you invite to speak? What question would you ask?

3. You are teaching a Yale course. What is it called? Compassion. I would love every Yalie to be concerned about challenges facing their society. To bring to an end the apathetic acts of complaining and commenting without any effort to make a difference.

4. Most first year Yale students live in suites of four to six students. What would you contribute to the dynamic of your suite? My Kenyan culture and cooking will bring a touch of diversity. My dry jokes and memes will be a daily pressure relief. My good music taste and corny dance moves will be a constant source of delight.

Prior education outside your country No

Essay Topic #1

Coding. Pretty easy, right?

Wrong!

Coming from Kericho town, Kenya, where power blackouts are the norm, learning to code came to mirror my daily cold showers. I recall being a beginner coming to terms with coding; learning Python had me at my wit's end. The countless times I found flaws in my scripts taught me the meaning of endurance. With this shortcoming, I shuddered at the edge of the shower stall away from the dripping water, contemplating ways around it. All the mode dependencies, function arguments and dynamic variables made it significantly easier to give up as the sophistication increased. Inevitably, my arms and legs took the plunge first in facing the chilly droplets.

Then reality struck again - *SyntaxError: invalid syntax*.

I withdrew my arms and legs as soon as they made contact with the ice water.

I hit the enter key again; nothing happened. Nevertheless, I gathered my courage and jumped into the dripping torrents with my teeth and fists clenched.

I learnt to embrace coding as a steppingstone for innovation and the world of computer science became my mind's innovation hub. Refreshed, I departed the shower, eager to turn my dreams into coded scripts that I believe will transform the scope of global technology.

I draw great strength from cold showers, strength to put on a brave face when confronting whatever life throws my way. And with each new series of code I grasp, solutions to pressing problems that face Kenya appear much closer.

Second Essay Choice Topic #2

In January, I joined Promoting Access to Community Education (PACE) as a volunteer teaching assistant at Madaraka Primary, a poorly-funded public school in Nairobi.

Together with my fellow volunteers, we alleviated the shortage of teachers in the school leading to a remarkable improvement in student performance. I also initiated different projects in the school, such as setting up an ICT center, renovating the school library, instigating counselling sessions, and training a soccer team.

During my interaction with the students, they opened up about their fears of a recurrence of post-election violence as Kenya's 2017 general elections were imminent. Bitterly, they explained how politicians incited their families to resort to bloodshed if they did not secure their desired government positions. In light of this pressing issue, I teamed up with the school administration to initiate the "Watoto Wetu" movement where we held family visits in the students' neighborhoods to encourage unity during elections. The school counselor led the interactions emphasizing the importance of peace in building their children's futures. The outreach movement continued until we had visited every student's home.

My experience with the students at Madaraka Primary was invaluable. The elections were conducted peacefully and no cases of violence were reported in Madaraka. The cheerful smiles on the students' faces as they walk to school every morning tell volumes of

the impact I made in their lives. Furthermore, each letter of gratitude I receive from them fuel my pursuit to revolutionize my community in my own small way.

Are you in the process of applying for an ROTC Scholarship? No

Engineering Essay

I've been enthralled by computers for as long as I can remember. I recall accompanying my uncle to his workplace at a nearby college, watching in admiration as he worked on computers. He resolved all computer hitches from exasperating viruses to hardware snags. The expression on his colleagues' faces set my soul ablaze: the expression of silent gratitude. It did more than any words could, it gave me a purpose.

With a burning desire to learn more about computers, I persistently asked my uncle countless questions about what they were made of, how their systems worked and which tasks they performed. Unfortunately, my knowledge about computers could only go as far as my uncle's explanations at the time. Computers were scarce in my hometown and access to the few that were available was very limited. Consequently, I cherished the rare opportunities I had to tag along to the college.

Over the years, my mere curiosity about the structure and functioning of computers transformed into a deep fascination for their sophistication. Subsequently, I pioneered the computer science club in high school where I spearheaded the establishment of an ICT center. Moreover, following frequent unreported cases of destruction and abuse of dorm property by students, I created a program that enabled dorm officials to keep track of every dorm's property information in a centralized database system. The program was integrated into the school system in no time, a milestone that fueled my thirst for more ventures in computer science.

To satisfy my craving for discovery, I look to Yale. With its exemplary undergraduate Computer Science program, I would be able to bring my dream to life under the guidance and support of inspirational thinkers who share my interests. Particularly Professor Brian Scassellati, who focuses on making a difference in the future of infants with disorders of social development. I can't help but fantasize about taking a joint class with Harvard University in CPSC 100 under world-renowned faculty members. Furthermore, Yale's liberal education would enable me to jointly pursue my interests in Economics as well. Yet with all there is to gain at Yale, there is so much to give. I intend to join Code Haven whose community service activities match my visions for Kenya's technological future. Mainly because of the irony in our current mentality of creating an advanced world when more than half of Kenya's population has no idea of the glaring impact of computers in their world. I long to change this narrative to a future where every Kenyan will share the joy of computer literacy in a world run by computers.

Computer scientists from all regions have inspiring stories to tell, every one as magical as the last, including Yale's own, Rob Glaser. I would love mine to join theirs, telling how I made a difference in my home country, inspiring younger computer scientists all around the world and how I had no doubt in my mind that I would achieve the greatest heights at Yale.

Yale-NUS: An Opportunity in Asia

Yale-NUS Application No

B.A./M.M. - An Option Available to Exceptional Musicians

B.A./M.M. Program Interest No

Affirmations

By submitting this application, I affirm my understanding of and agreement to the statements found here:
<http://www.commonapp.org/affirmations>.